

The Boston Globe

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UPHEAVAL IN ISRAEL



OHAD ZWIGENBERG/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Thousands of demonstrators closed down the main highway into Jerusalem on Wednesday before converging outside the Parliament building to call for a renewed cease-fire with Hamas and to protest political moves by Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, including firing the head of the Shin Bet intelligence agency. Israel resumed its deadly aerial attacks across the Gaza Strip the day before. **A4.**



AMIR LEVY/GETTY IMAGES

Facing chaos, scientists may look beyond US

Foreign countries hope to capitalize with offers of funding and stability

By Hilary Burns and Mike Damiano
GLOBE STAFF

Foreign governments are trying to lure US scientists to move abroad as the Trump administration roils the research world with funding cuts and blacklists of some fields.

Higher education leaders said scientists in Massachusetts are already receiving overtures, prompting Governor Maura Healey to raise the alarm about a potential brain drain from research institutions that form the backbone of the state's economy.

Countries in the Middle East and Europe, as well as China, are telling Massachusetts scientists, "We'll give you a lab, we'll give you staff," Healey said Monday at Boston

Children's Hospital.

"We're giving away assets to other countries instead of training them, growing them, supporting them here," she said.

►The Trump administration suspended \$175 million in funding for the University of Pennsylvania over a transgender swimmer. **C1.**

The recruiting Healey described is part of a widespread effort by foreign governments and research groups to capitalize on the turmoil convulsing the scientific community in the United States. As the Trump administration cancels research grants, moves to slash billions in research funding, **SCIENTISTS, Page A7**

Vets fear VA cuts endanger research

Clinical studies threatened

By Chris Serres and Katie Johnston
GLOBE STAFF

Dave Crocker is a former Navy sailor who spent two years aboard the USS Tiran-te, a fast-attack submarine that torpedoed Japanese warships in World War II.

And Bob Bruno repaired electronics for an air-defense artillery system that was designed to shoot down enemy aircraft in combat.

After leaving the military, both men volunteered to serve their country in a novel way. They joined an army of citizen scientists who advise the Department of Veterans Affairs — which oversees the nation's largest integrated health system — on how to improve medical care for the 9.1 million veterans enrolled. As research consultants for the VA, they have helped design screening tools for lung cancer, new telehealth initiatives, and strategies for combating social isolation.

"It's been an incredibly rewarding experience, knowing that I am giving back to my fellow veterans," said Bruno, 69, of Arlington, who served in the Army and Massachusetts Air National Guard in the 1980s.

Now, both veterans have **VETERANS, Page A7**



Another Trump story. Do you want to read it?

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

The first time President Trump took office, media consumers had a reaction so pronounced that it got its own name: a "Trump bump" of audiences flocking to sources such as news websites and TV programs, which helped those organizations recover some of the readers and viewers they'd lost in past decades.

This time around, however, Trump's ascent has spurred a different kind of response. There are signs of a second, much smaller Trump bump, but many consumers are simply tuning out — exhausted by the years of high-intensity politics that preceded Trump's aggressive return. Meanwhile, the increasingly fragmented media landscape has some people turning away from mainstream news entirely, looking instead to newsletters, podcasts, and other alternative sources.

These trends cut across ideological lines, unlike much else in this historically polarized moment. The Globe heard from dozens of New England residents about **MEDIA, Page A6**

Wu hails Boston's role in the resistance

Riders fear mayor is retreating on bike and bus lanes

By Emma Platoff and Shannon Larson
GLOBE STAFF

Michelle Wu ran for Boston mayor as a champion for transit infrastructure: bus lanes, bike lanes, safer crosswalks — anything to get more people out of their cars and to build a greener city. In her first three years in office, she made three bus routes fare-free and expanded the network of bike lanes, sometimes even cycling to work herself.

Now, facing intense backlash for some of those changes and up for reelection, Wu is striking a much different tone and even undoing some of those additions, leaving cyclists, bus riders, and transit advocates worried her commitment is waning.

In the last several weeks, the city has axed a bus lane on Boylston Street, yanked protective barriers out of bike lanes in multiple neighborhoods, and announced a 30-day "review" of all road infrastructure changes made during the last three years. Some non-car commuters are worried they might lose more bus and protected bike lanes that they have come to rely on.

The changes have been particularly startling for cyclists, who have for the most part counted **TRANSIT, Page A10**

'No one tells Boston how to take care of our own. Not kings, and not presidents who think they are kings. Boston was born facing down bullies.'

MAYOR MICHELLE WU



BRETT PHELPS FOR THE GLOBE

"The state of our city is strong," Mayor Michelle Wu said Wednesday night.

In speech, she says city won't be cowed

By Niki Griswold and Emma Platoff
GLOBE STAFF

The speech was about Boston, but the national context loomed large in Mayor Michelle Wu's third annual State of the City address Wednesday.

Wu struck a notably defiant tone, positioning Boston under her tenure as a shining example of successful, progressive leadership ready to stand strong against attacks from Washington, D.C. And while she never mentioned President Trump by name, Wu from the start of the speech to its closing words asserted that neither she nor the city would be cowed by the administration's threats or ad hominem attacks on her and other Boston officials.

In doing so, Wu leaned heavily into the wave of support she rode after defending Boston and its public safety and immigration-related policies before a Republican-led congressional committee earlier in March.

"Tonight, I can say that the state of our city is strong — and we have to be," Wu said to thousands gathered at MGM Music Hall. "Because all over the country, people are feeling the weight of a federal administration that's attacking our sources of strength — the same people and purpose that make Boston great: **SPEECH, Page A10**



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Weather and Comics, D5-6.

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State officials are preparing for the possible collapse of Commonwealth Care Alliance and hope to protect its 50,000 elderly, disabled, and low-income members. **D1.**

State Trooper Michael Proctor was fired months after sending crude and misogynistic texts about Karen Read at her trial. **B1.**

Should you be worried about Social Security cuts? Sean P. Murphy has some answers. **The Fine Print, D1.**

Two Boston-based law

firms received letters from the Trump administration seeking information about employment practices related to DEI. **B1.**

The Federal Reserve kept its benchmark interest rate unchanged and signaled it still expects to cut rates twice this year. **D1.**

Turkish police arrested Istanbul's mayor, a key rival of President Recep Tayyip Erdogan. **A5.**

Fans of Twin Donuts lined up to say farewell to an Allston fixture for 70 years. **D1.**



EFREM LUKATSKY/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A WELCOME EXCHANGE

Some Ukrainian servicemen held by Russia returned home Wednesday in the Chernihiv region as part of a POW swap. Meanwhile, President Volodymyr Zelensky agreed in a phone call with President Trump to accept Russia's offer for a mutual pause in attacks on energy targets for 30 days. **A2.**